Hair2Harvest
Preliminary Interview Raw Data & Research Notes

Barbershops only • Barangay Novaliches Proper • Working evidence compilation

Sample Six interviewed barbershops (individual respondent identities and full transcripts not provided).

Evidence at a glance

Evidence type	What is available
Interviews	Answer excerpts from 13 interview questions across 6 shops
Field photographs	4 pictures of shop waste storage
Barangay / SK information	Reported absence of a separate hair program, existing environmental activities
Online research	Screenshots of AI/search summaries about QC waste handling and environmental risks

Part A. Consolidated barbershop interview answer excerpts

DATA NOTE The answers below preserve the wording supplied by the group. Answer numbers are excerpts, NOT Respondent 1, Respondent 2, etc.

Q1. How many haircut or hair-trimming customers do you usually serve in a day?

1. 30 total per day
2. 12-15 per barber (they have 3 barbers)
3. 30, tho it depends if maraming suki na nagpapagupit
4. Mas malakas kapad sabado linggo ganyan pero more on linggo kasi walang pasok sa trabaho

Q2. Approximately how much discarded hair does your shop generate in a day or week?

1. Nakakapuno kami ng isang sako sa isang araw
2. Sa isang week yung sako namin puno ng buhok yun kasi iniipon namin kasi weekly kinukuha yung basura

Q3. What do you usually do with the discarded hair after a haircut?

1. Ini-store lang sa basurahan namin tapos hihintayin na makolekta ng truck ng basura
2. Sineseparate namin yung basura sa basurahan lang ng buhok
3. Nilalagay lang sa basura

Q4. Is the hair separated from other trash, or is it mixed with general waste?

1. No, mixed na siya
2. Kasama na rin dun yung general waste namin (tissue, plastic bottles, etc) na makikita sa shop pagka closing na

Q5. Who collects your waste, and how often is it collected?

1. Yung truck lang ng basura na umiikot kada week, nilalagay lang namin yung mga naipon na sako ng buhok sa labas ng shop tapos may kukuha na nyan
2. Hinihintay lang namin yung kukuha na truck kasi wala namang designated na basurahan para sa mga buhok

Q6. Have you experienced any problem in storing or disposing of discarded hair?

1. Wala naman, kasi kinikolekta lang namin yung tapos nilalagay sa basurahan namin para maipon hanggang sa makapuno ng isang sako tapos hintay na lang makolekta
2. May issue dati dito yung isang barber shop na tinatapon lang nila yung buhok na naiipon nila sa drainage and nagkaroon ng malalang clog. Napasara naman na yung barber shop na yun pero hindi naman kami nagkaroon ng mga designated basurahan o may mangongolekta ganon, sa mga general waste lang siya nasasama.

Q7. Do you think discarded hair can cause cleanliness or waste problems? Why or why not?

1. Tbh, kapag naman nakolekta na yan and wala na sa shop namin, wala na kaming pake. Pero, kung tutuusin lang e may problema talaga yan lalo na sa environment kasi hindi naman madali matunaw yung buhok, so may possibility na magdagdag pa yan sa mga kalat tapos mag-clog ng mga drianage
2. Yes, matagal malusaw yung mga buhok e so siguro dun sa tapunan ng mga basura marami dyan na puro buhok lang, ewan ko pano yan nila inaasikaso

DATA NOTE A third item originally entered under Q7 began “(WHAT WE FOUND OUT)” and described a potential methane-emission mechanism for landfilled hair. Because it was presented as researcher-found information rather than a barbershop statement, it is preserved separately in Part C, not treated as an interview response.

Q8. Would you be willing to separate and temporarily keep discarded hair for a research study?

1. All of them said yes

DATA NOTE “All of them said yes” was supplied by the group as a summary for all six interviewed establishments; no individual recorded responses were provided.

Q9. How often do you think collected hair could be picked up from your shop?

1. Dito everyday nakokolekta kasi sa mall kami naka-place, yung mall kinoklekta yun everyday
2. Mga twice a week
3. Every week

Q10. What concerns would you have about giving discarded hair for a composting or fertilizer project?

1. Kung talaga bang gagana sya and talagang magiging pataba sa mga halaman kasi buhok yun e, matagal matunaw yun so pano mangyayari dun

Q11. Do you know if the hair is usually chemically treated (e.g., dyed, bleached, rebonded), or is it mostly ordinary haircut waste?

1. Kung out of 10 ang bilang siguro 9 our ot 10 e puro virgin o natural hair naman kasi sa barber shop mostly ang nagpapagupit ay lalaki and madalas sa mga lalaki e wala namang mga kulay yung buhok
2. Meron namang mga nagpapagupit na may kulang yung buhok siguro mga 15% sa mga nagiging client everyday

Q12. Would you be willing to be one of the participating shops if the barangay and researchers proceed with the project?

1. Yes

Q13. Other comments or suggestions.

1. If kukunin nyo yung buhok dito sa shop namin dapat every night kasi everyday to kinukuha ng mall and if di makukuha matatambak di naman pwede matambakan kami ng buhok
2. Dapat twice a week tapos may specific schedule kayo
3. If kokolektahin nyo yung hair, dapat kayo ang kukuha hindi yung kami and need punmunta sa brgy kasi may work kami e, di namin pwede ma-absentan to

Part B. Additional field notes and photographs

B1. Additional information reported by the group

- The brgy doesn't provide separate hair waste management
- The brgy has a lot of barber shops

DATA NOTE These notes were supplied by the group. The first should be confirmed in writing with the appropriate barangay waste-management officer; "a lot" has not been quantified.

Earlier SK conversation (reported through screenshots): SK contacts reportedly said the barangay has a project involving "niyog" and animal feces rather than hair, and no separate hair-waste management. These are preliminary informal statements; not an official written technical finding.

B2. Candidate barbershops identified by the group

1. Supremo Barbershop – Susano
2. Vins Barbershop
3. DT Barbershop
4. Michael's Barbershop
5. John Robert Barbershop
6. Supremo Barbershop – Regalado
7. Hawaii Barber
8. Olympic Barber Shop
9. Omorfos Barbershop

DATA NOTE This is a candidate list, not a verified list of all licensed shops, and not a key linking these names to the six interviews. Confirm barangay boundaries and which six actually participated before creating a sampling table.

B3. Photographic evidence from local shop waste containers

Photo F-01: Open white sack

Hair-like clippings, crumpled paper/tissue, and printed packaging are visible in the same sack. Supports an observation of mixed waste in this photographed container.



Record still needed: Shop ID: _____ Photo date: _____ Consent/permission: _____

Photo F-02: Exterior of waste sack

Shows the exterior of a large sack used as a waste container. The amount or composition of contents cannot be determined from this exterior view.



Record still needed: Shop ID: _____ Photo date: _____ Consent/permission: _____

Photo F-03: Covered foot-pedal waste bin

Shows a closed container. Contents and segregation practices cannot be assessed from this image alone.



Record still needed: Shop ID: _____ Photo date: _____ Consent/permission: _____

Photo F-04: Open black waste bin

Visible hair clippings mixed with tissue/paper and other material. Supports an observation of mixed waste in this photographed container.



Record still needed: Shop ID: _____ Photo date: _____ Consent/permission: _____

Part C. Online research notes from supplied screenshots (UNVERIFIED)

The following points are preserved from the screenshots of online/AI-generated answers shared by the group. They are research leads, not substantiated evidence. The screenshots mention websites or laws, but the original primary sources, exact passages, and current local implementation have not yet been checked.

C1. Claimed waste routes and environmental programs

Screenshot claim / lead	Verification needed
Barangay Novaliches Proper reportedly diverts some coconut husks and kitchen/organic wastes for vermicomposting or community processing.	Ask barangay for name, operator, documentation, feedstock and operating status.
Sharon Farm reportedly has a city-supported biodigester that can process kitchen/organic waste into biogas and digestate or liquid products.	Confirm with barangay/urban farm and government records; clarify whether the unit is active.
QC Department of Sanitation and Cleanup Works (DSQC) reportedly handles regular collection, with residual waste ultimately taken to a Rizal-area sanitary landfill.	Request official haulage and disposal information, specifically about barbershop clippings.
Hair from local shops reportedly enters ordinary municipal/commercial garbage collection.	Interviews support some shops using regular collection, but route beyond pickup is not yet documented.

C2. Claims about regulation, segregation, and pickup schedules

Screenshot claim / lead	Verification needed
P.D. 856 and related rules reportedly require barbershops to sweep and collect hair clippings into proper refuse receptacles.	Check the precise implementing rule; do not infer that it mandates a specialized hair recycling program.

One screenshot classified hair as "non-biodegradable residual waste"; another called it "biodegradable organic waste or special commercial refuse."	The screenshots are inconsistent. Seek the current QC/DSQC classification in an official document.
Screenshot claimed daily/twice-daily collection on main commercial roads and specific alternate-day schedules for residential streets.	Confirm shop-specific collection arrangements with QC/contractor. Do not assume citywide uniformity.
Commercial clearance, sanitary permits, separate receptacles for sharps, and recurring inspection requirements were mentioned.	Verify exact requirements with QC business licensing, health department and official rules.

C3. Environmental risk and recycling claims

Screenshot claim / lead	How to treat it in the paper
Hair contains keratin and decomposes slowly.	Find peer-reviewed decomposition/composting studies and state the method and actual tested duration.
Hair in landfill releases methane due to anaerobic decomposition.	General landfill methane is not proof of significant methane from local hair waste; find hair-specific evidence before claiming impacts.
Hair can create toxic leachate, contaminate groundwater or contribute to street flooding and clogged drainage.	Treat as hypotheses/possible mechanisms, not measured local outcomes. One drainage incident was secondhand anecdote.
One kilogram of hair contains as much nitrogen as 15–30 kilograms of cow manure.	Do not use numeric comparison without an original reputable study and comparable nitrogen analysis.
Hair can be reused as compost feedstock or oil-absorbent mats.	Find original experimental studies and describe the applicable processing and safety limitations.

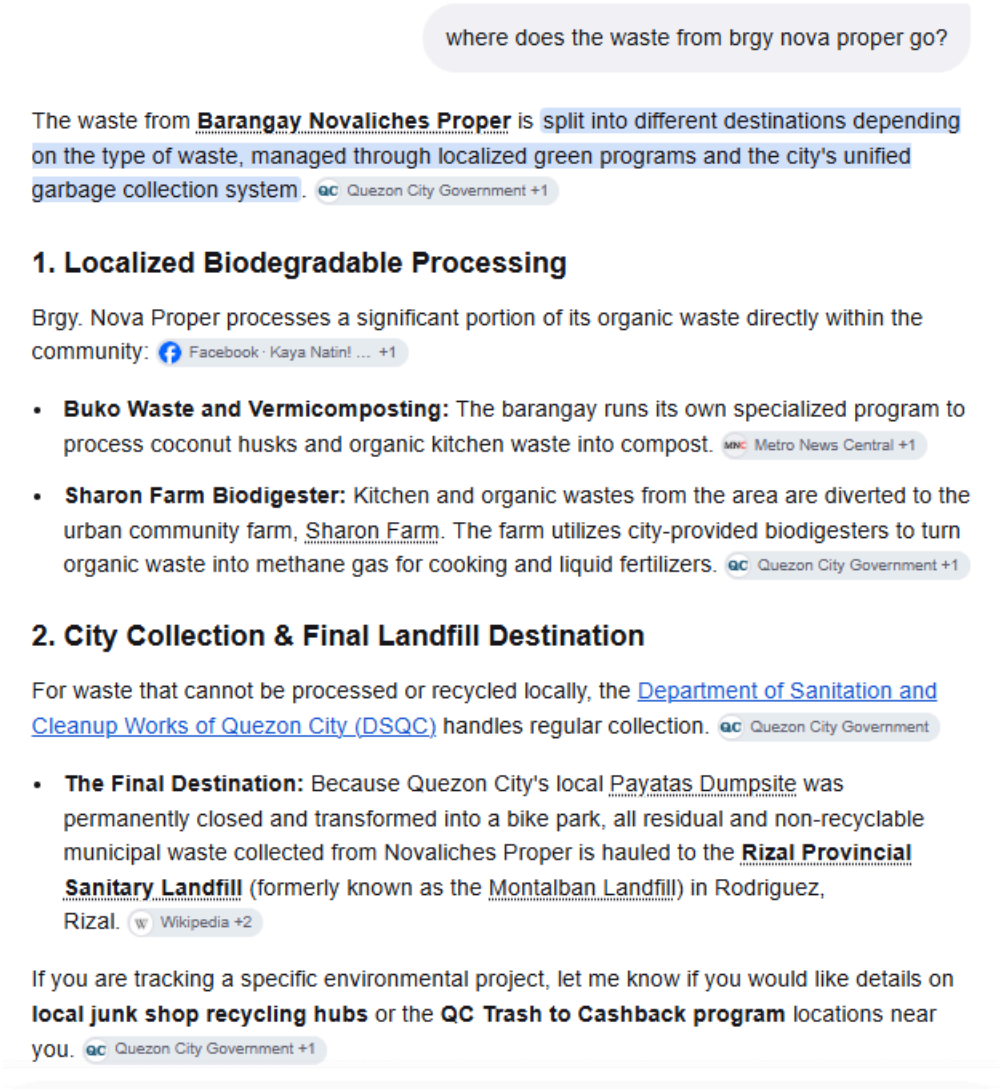
Additional note entered by the group under Interview Q7, but NOT a respondent quotation:

(WHAT WE FOUND OUT) Hair is organic matter. When packed into plastic garbage bags and buried under tons of trash in a sanitary landfill, it decomposes anaerobically (without oxygen). This process releases methane, a greenhouse gas.

DATA NOTE This is a researcher-supplied claim requiring a suitable scientific source and specific caution about local inference.

C4. Supplied screenshots of online research

Research screenshot R-01: reported waste destinations and local projects



where does the waste from brgy nova proper go?

The waste from **Barangay Novaliches Proper** is split into different destinations depending on the type of waste, managed through localized green programs and the city's unified garbage collection system. Quezon City Government +1

1. Localized Biodegradable Processing

Brgy. Nova Proper processes a significant portion of its organic waste directly within the community: Facebook · Kaya Natin! ... +1

- **Buko Waste and Vermicomposting:** The barangay runs its own specialized program to process coconut husks and organic kitchen waste into compost. Metro News Central +1
- **Sharon Farm Biodigester:** Kitchen and organic wastes from the area are diverted to the urban community farm, Sharon Farm. The farm utilizes city-provided biodigesters to turn organic waste into methane gas for cooking and liquid fertilizers. Quezon City Government +1

2. City Collection & Final Landfill Destination

For waste that cannot be processed or recycled locally, the Department of Sanitation and Cleanup Works of Quezon City (DSQC) handles regular collection. Quezon City Government

- **The Final Destination:** Because Quezon City's local Payatas Dumpsite was permanently closed and transformed into a bike park, all residual and non-recyclable municipal waste collected from Novaliches Proper is hauled to the **Rizal Provincial Sanitary Landfill** (formerly known as the Montalban Landfill) in Rodriguez, Rizal. Wikipedia +2

If you are tracking a specific environmental project, let me know if you would like details on **local junk shop recycling hubs** or the **QC Trash to Cashback program** locations near you. Quezon City Government +1

Screenshot archived as originally supplied; its assertions have not been independently checked.

Research screenshot R-02: claimed hair pickup and classification

yes

Operating a commercial business like a barbershop in Novaliches means managing both **strict city licensing regulations** and navigating the **dual-track garbage collection system** designed by the city.

1. Strict Commercial Clearance Requirements

To operate a tonsorial (barbershop/salon) establishment legally in Quezon City, owners must secure mandatory legal clearances annually. If any shop fails to meet these, the city can issue an Environmental Violation Receipt (EVR) or deny the Mayor's Business Permit: QC Quezon City Government +2

- **Dual Technical Clearances:** Businesses must apply online via the QC eServices BOSS Portal. They need an **Environmental Clearance** from the Department of Sanitation and Cleanup Works of Quezon City (DSQC) alongside a **Sanitary Permit** from the QC Health Department. QC Quezon City Government +3
- **The Dual-Receptacle Mandate:** Under P.D. 856, barbershops must strictly implement a two-tier segregation system inside the shop. They must have distinct bins for regular dry waste (like hair clippings and neck strips) and separate, puncture-proof bins for sharps or potentially infectious waste (like used razor blades). Supreme Court E-Library
- **Mandatory Routine Inspections:** Local health officers and DSQC enforcement agents are legally mandated to conduct field inspections at least once every three months. They check for proper waste segregation, active pest/vermin control records, and valid health certificates for every single barber or stylist on staff. QC Quezon City Government +2

2. Residential vs. Commercial Collection Schedules

The DSQC structures its hauling routes strategically to keep high-traffic business districts clear without leaving residential zones behind: QC Quezon City Government

Screenshot archived as originally supplied; its assertions have not been independently checked.

Research screenshot R-03: claimed commercial regulations

2. Residential vs. Commercial Collection Schedules

The DSQC structures its hauling routes strategically to keep high-traffic business districts clear without leaving residential zones behind: QC Quezon City Government

Collection Zone	Target Areas in Novaliches	Frequency & Rules
Main Roads & Commercial Zones	Quirino Highway, Gen. Luis, and commercial strips inside Brgy. Nova Proper	**Daily, Twice-a-Day collection.** Due to high waste volume and strict sidewalk clearing policies, commercial trucks run multiple times.
Residential Subdivisions & Blocks	Inner streets, residential clusters, and local compounds	**Alternating Schedule.** DSQC deploys white trucks on a fixed weekly split: • *Biodegradable (Monday, Wednesday, Friday)* • *Non-Biodegradable (Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday)*

Note: Paleros (garbage collectors) are strictly prohibited from charging businesses or residents any collection fees. Any tipping extortion should be reported directly to the QC Helpline 122. QC Quezon City Government

Screenshot archived as originally supplied; its assertions have not been independently checked.

Research screenshot R-04: additional claimed collection schedules

so the hair waste from barber shops in the brgy are collected by the city collection?

Yes, hair waste from local barbershops is handled through the regular city waste collection. Under [the Code on Sanitation of the Philippines (P.D. 856)] (https://elibrary.judiciary.gov.ph/thebookshelf/showdocs/10/41807 ""TONSORIAL AND BEAUTY ESTABLISHMENTS" OF THE ..."), all tonsorial establishments are required to collect hair clippings after every customer and place them into refuse receptacles. Supreme Court E-Library

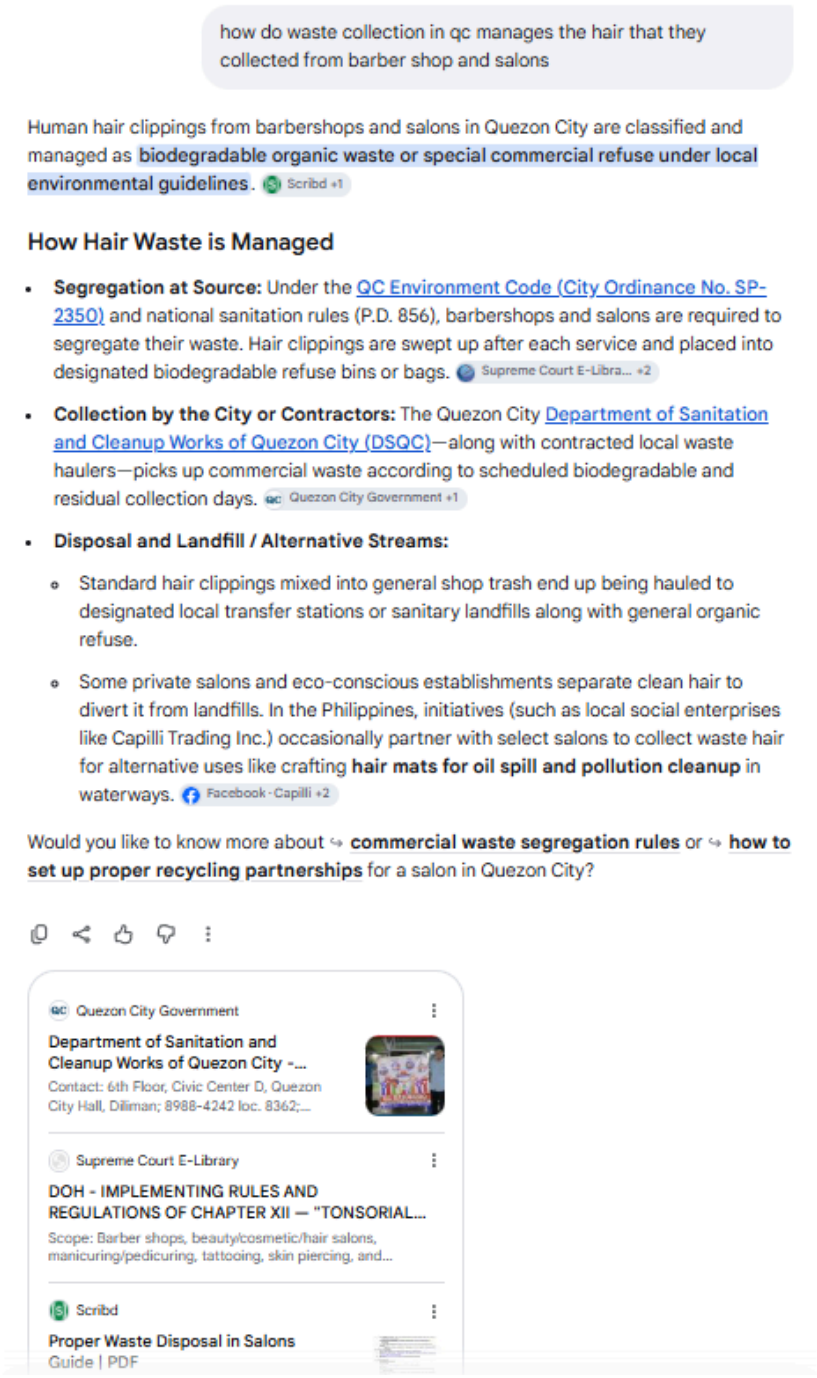
Because hair cannot be recycled through local junk shops or standard programs, it follows the city's general municipal waste stream:

- **Segregation Category:** Local shops bag hair clippings as **non-biodegradable residual waste**. While hair is technically organic and biodegradable over long periods, it takes years to decompose naturally. Mixing it into the barangay's localized fast-composting or vermicomposting systems (like the buko and kitchen waste programs) ruins the compost quality because it clogs the bins and entangles the machinery. Metro News Central
- **Collection and Logistics:** The Department of Sanitation and Cleanup Works of Quezon City (DSQC) dumps it during scheduled residual/non-biodegradable pickup days. Quezon City Government
- **Final Destination:** The city haulers transport the collected bags out of Novaliches directly to the **Rizal Provincial Sanitary Landfill** in Rodriguez, Rizal for permanent disposal.

If you are managing a shop or studying local practices, would you like to know about **Quezon City's strict sanitation clearance requirements** for commercial businesses, or details on how the DSQC schedules commercial zones versus residential subdivisions in Novaliches?

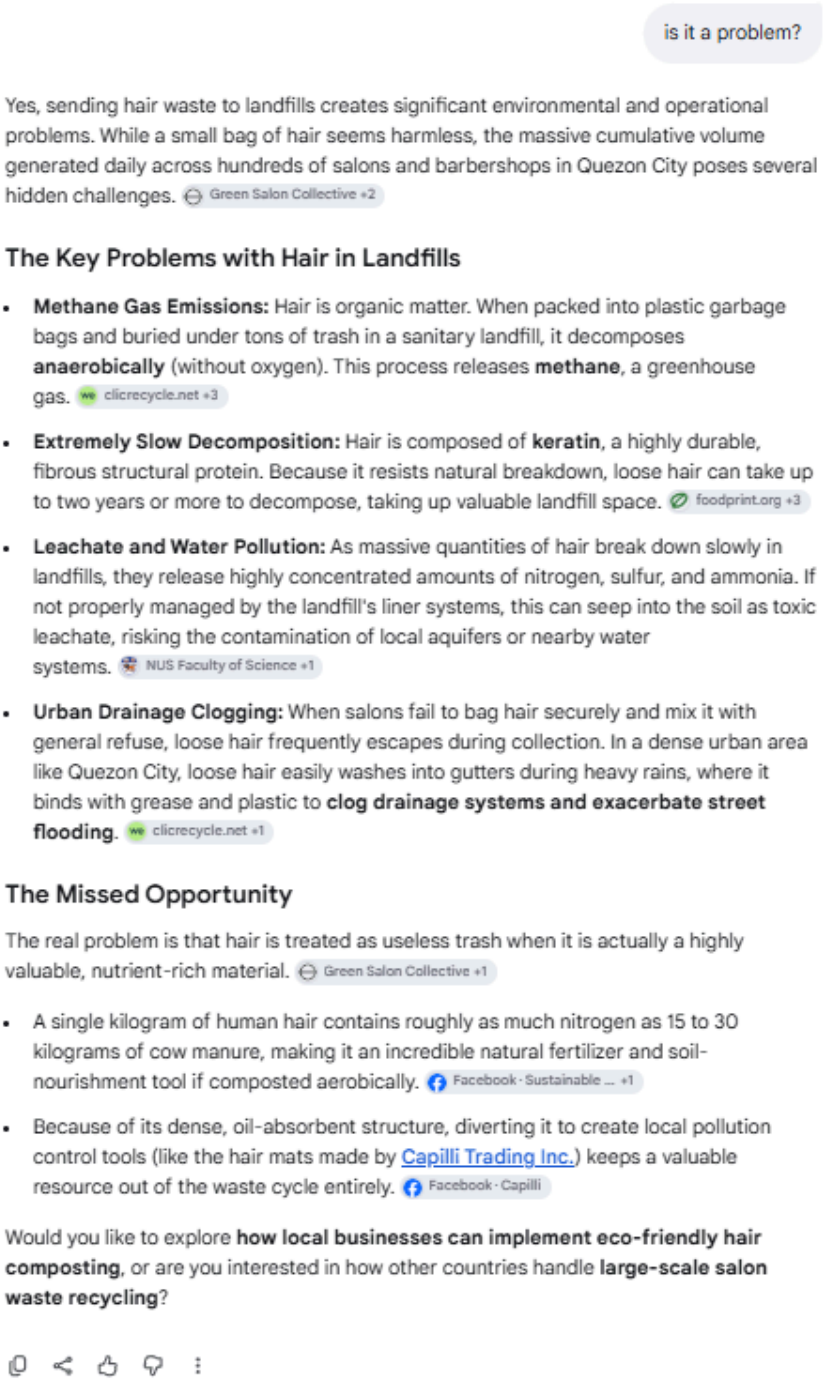
Screenshot archived as originally supplied; its assertions have not been independently checked.

Research screenshot R-05: claimed management of hair waste in QC



Screenshot archived as originally supplied; its assertions have not been independently checked.

Research screenshot R-06: claimed environmental impacts of hair in landfills



is it a problem?

Yes, sending hair waste to landfills creates significant environmental and operational problems. While a small bag of hair seems harmless, the massive cumulative volume generated daily across hundreds of salons and barbershops in Quezon City poses several hidden challenges. Green Salon Collective +2

The Key Problems with Hair in Landfills

- **Methane Gas Emissions:** Hair is organic matter. When packed into plastic garbage bags and buried under tons of trash in a sanitary landfill, it decomposes **anaerobically** (without oxygen). This process releases **methane**, a greenhouse gas. clicrecycle.net +3
- **Extremely Slow Decomposition:** Hair is composed of **keratin**, a highly durable, fibrous structural protein. Because it resists natural breakdown, loose hair can take up to two years or more to decompose, taking up valuable landfill space. foodprint.org +3
- **Leachate and Water Pollution:** As massive quantities of hair break down slowly in landfills, they release highly concentrated amounts of nitrogen, sulfur, and ammonia. If not properly managed by the landfill's liner systems, this can seep into the soil as toxic leachate, risking the contamination of local aquifers or nearby water systems. NUS Faculty of Science +1
- **Urban Drainage Clogging:** When salons fail to bag hair securely and mix it with general refuse, loose hair frequently escapes during collection. In a dense urban area like Quezon City, loose hair easily washes into gutters during heavy rains, where it binds with grease and plastic to **clog drainage systems and exacerbate street flooding**. clicrecycle.net +1

The Missed Opportunity

The real problem is that hair is treated as useless trash when it is actually a highly valuable, nutrient-rich material. Green Salon Collective +1

- A single kilogram of human hair contains roughly as much nitrogen as 15 to 30 kilograms of cow manure, making it an incredible natural fertilizer and soil-nourishment tool if composted aerobically. Facebook · Sustainable ... +1
- Because of its dense, oil-absorbent structure, diverting it to create local pollution control tools (like the hair mats made by Capilli Trading Inc.) keeps a valuable resource out of the waste cycle entirely. Facebook · Capilli

Would you like to explore **how local businesses can implement eco-friendly hair composting**, or are you interested in how other countries handle **large-scale salon waste recycling**?

Screenshot archived as originally supplied; its assertions have not been independently checked.

Part D. Evidence-based preliminary problem statements (ANALYSIS)

DATA NOTE The points below are synthesis by the documentation team/assistant, not raw interview quotations and not independently verified regulatory findings.

D1. Main documented gap

Among the six interviewed barbershops, discarded human hair was often stored in ordinary sacks or bins until routine waste pickup. Some interview excerpts and two photographs indicate hair was mixed with other shop waste. The group has not documented a dedicated hair-recovery chain for those shops.

D2. Collection coordination

Shops described different pickup patterns and stated that an additional research collection should be done at the shop on an agreed schedule. This is a design requirement for a pilot recovery program, not proof that routine municipal collection is failing.

D3. Feasibility opportunity

The group reported that all six shops were willing to participate in segregating and supplying hair. This establishes preliminary interest, but actual weekly recoverable mass and long-term participation remain unknown.

D4. Processing remains unproven

The interviews do not demonstrate that a particular hair-and-organic-waste recipe can yield mature, safe compost. This requires expert-guided experiments, biological processing time, curing, and safety/quality evaluation.

D5. Do not overclaim environmental harm

Most respondents did not report significant personal disposal problems. Drainage clogging was reported as a secondhand past incident; the interviews do not establish local pollution, landfill methane, quantified landfill impact, or disease risks.

Part E. Information still needed for Chapter 1 and methodology

- Shop-by-shop interview matrix: respondent code, actual interview date, shop location/eligibility, role, raw answer for each question, and consent status.
- Barangay written confirmation: whether a separate human-hair collection/recovery program exists, waste classification, destination after collection, and available records.
- Actual quantity: weigh segregated hair from several participating shops over agreed collection days; record sacks and measured kilograms separately.
- Photo log: connect each of four images to a shop code, date, photographer, and permission for use in the thesis.
- Source verification log: check primary versions of regulations and original scientific papers; record author, year, URL/DOI, exact finding, and limitations.
- Specialist consultation: composting/agriculture expert to review acceptable hair inputs, contamination screening, organic feedstock recipe, expected duration, maturity measures, and safety testing.
- Engineering review: assess plastic drum, guards, electrical safety, interlocks, motor and website-operated commands before biological trials.

Suggested defensible problem formulation for drafting (not raw data): A preliminary recovery and coordination gap was observed among participating barbershops because discarded hair is generally managed through existing waste collection rather than a separate, documented hair recovery arrangement. Hair2Harvest will investigate a pilot segregation and collection process and evaluate whether the recovered material can be safely co-composted with other organic waste using an IoT-assisted system.

END OF WORKING EVIDENCE FILE